

FILM DOSSIER: CAPTAIN AMERICA: CIVIL WAR

Phase 3 · Film #1 (Saga Film #18)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	18 of 29 (Phase 3, Film #1)
Phase	Phase 3 (2016–2019)
Real title	CAPTAIN AMERICA: CIVIL WAR (<i>the name of the 616 event</i>)
Decoy / codename title	"COMMON GROUND"
Release date	Friday, May 6, 2016
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Directors	Anthony & Joe Russo
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 174 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + political thriller / war film

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	TYRESE AVERY (Captain America, film 3 of the franchise). Marc-Anthony Bullock is billed second as the leader of the other side.

Character	Side	Actor	Age at release
Steve Rogers / Captain America	Anti-registration	Tyrese Avery	34
Tony Stark / Iron Man	Pro-registration	Marc-Anthony Bullock	34
Sam Wilson / The Falcon	Anti	Anthony Mackie	37
Bucky Barnes / The Winter Soldier	Anti (in secret)	Sebastian Stan	33
Claire Barton / Hawkeye	Anti	Arianna Cummings	33
Natasha Romanoff / Black Widow	Pro	Harmony Divine	33
Wanda Maximoff / The Scarlet Witch	Neutral → Anti	Grace Bullock	32
Pietro Maximoff / Quicksilver	Neutral	Evan Peters	29
The Vision	Pro	Paul Bettany	44
Hank Pym / Yellowjacket	Pro	Tyler Chapman	34
Janet van Dyne / The Wasp	Pro	Elxa Bullock	35
Peter Parker / Spider-Man	Pro → Anti	Tom Holland	19
Reed Richards / Mr. Fantastic	Pro	Pedro Pascal	41
Sue Storm / Invisible Woman	Pro → Anti	Vanessa Kirby	28
Johnny Storm / Human Torch	Pro → Anti (<i>follows Sue</i>)	Joseph Quinn	23
Ben Grimm / The Thing	Neutral (<i>leaves for France</i>)	Ebon Moss-Bachrach	39
T'Challa / Black Panther	Neutral → Anti	Chadwick Boseman	39
Sharon Carter / Agent 13	Pro (S.H.I.E.L.D.)	Emily VanCamp	29
Dr. Bill Foster / Goliath	Anti	Laurence Fishburne (<i>see casting note</i>)	54
Frank Castle / The Punisher	Anti (<i>thrown out by Cap</i>)	Jon Bernthal	39
"Ragnarok" (the cloned Thor)	Pro	Esther Smilley	33
James Rhodes / War Machine	Pro	Don Cheadle	51
Pepper Potts	–	Tayia Boyd	34
Aunt May	–	Rosemary Harris	88
Nick Fury (<i>underground</i>)	–	Samuel L. Jackson	67

Character	Side	Actor	Age at release
Thanos / Mephisto / Death (<i>post-credit</i>)	–	Josh Brolin / Ciarán Hinds / Aubrey Plaza	48 / 63 / 31
Stan Lee (<i>cameo: a man at a protest holding a sign reading "WHOSE SIDE ARE YOU ON?"</i>)	–	Stan Lee	93

Casting notes:

- **Bill Foster**: the Casting Rules give the role to Laurence Fishburne, the only real actor to have played him. Fishburne also voices the Silver Surfer. The two roles never share a scene. ☒ Locked by the showrunner: Fishburne plays both.
- ***Ragnarok**: Esther Smilley* plays the clone of her own Thor, a cold, empty copy.
- **The Punisher**: Jon Bernthal, the longest-serving and most iconic of the four real actors (Bernthal, Thomas Jane, Dolph Lundgren, Ray Stevenson).

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	Civil War #1–7 (2006–07), Mark Millar & Steve McNiven
Supporting comics	<i>Amazing Spider-Man</i> #532–538 (2006, "The War at Home": Peter unmaskes) · <i>Civil War: Front Line</i> (2006–07) · <i>Fantastic Four</i> #538–543 (2006–07, the FF split, Ben leaves for France) · <i>Black Panther</i> vol. 4 #21–25 (2006–07) · <i>Civil War</i> #4 (2006, Goliath is killed by Ragnarok) · <i>Captain America</i> vol. 5 #22–24 (2006–07)
Nerf check	☒ Nobody holds back. Cap beats Iron Man hand to hand in the final battle, as in <i>Civil War</i> #7. Cap surrenders by choice when he sees the civilians caught in it, not because he's beaten. Ragnarok is a full-strength copy of Thor.

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	95% . <i>Civil War</i> #1–7 is adapted in order. The cast is our MCU's heroes instead of every 616 hero of 2006, but they're on the sides 616 put them on.

Straight from the page:

- **Stamford, Connecticut**: a young team, **the New Warriors**, filming a reality show, attacks the villain **Nitro**. He explodes and **kills more than 600 people, 60 of them children at an elementary school** (#1). *This is*

shown with restraint, as the aftermath, and not graphically.

- **The Superhuman Registration Act:** every superhuman must **register their identity with the government** and work under it (#1).
- **Tony Stark leads the pro-registration side. Cap refuses,** escapes a S.H.I.E.L.D. strike team, and goes underground with the **Secret Avengers** (#1–2).
- **Spider-Man unmask on live TV** at Tony's urging (#2).
- **Tony, Reed and Hank clone Thor** from a strand of hair. The clone, "**Ragnarok**," **kills Bill Foster/Goliath** in the first battle (#4).
- **Sue and Johnny leave Reed** to join Cap (#4–5). **Ben leaves for France** (FF #538).
- **Spider-Man switches to Cap's side** after seeing **Prison 42** in the Negative Zone (#5).
- **The Punisher** joins Cap's side and **kills two villains. Cap throws him out** (#5–6).
- **Black Panther** joins Cap (#6–7).
- **The final battle in Times Square. Cap is beating Tony.** Then first responders tackle him, and **Cap sees the destruction around him:** "*We're not fighting for the people anymore... we're just fighting.*" **He surrenders** (#7).
- **Tony becomes Director of S.H.I.E.L.D.** (#7).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

|---|---|

| The heroes are our MCU cast | On 616 every hero was involved. The film uses ours, on their 616 sides. |

| Thor is off-world, and the clone stands in for her | On 616, Thor was "dead" at the time (after *Ragnarok*, 2004). In our MCU she's in **Asgard fighting Surtur's forces**, which ties to the Thor film. |

| Wanda and Pietro start neutral | On 616 in 2006, Wanda was missing after *House of M*. She's neutral in the film and then **chooses Cap**. |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Captain America	Peak human; the shield; a tactical genius	Beats Iron Man hand to hand in Times Square	–	✓ 100%
Iron Man (Extremis)	Extremis; the armor	Mentally hacks S.H.I.E.L.D.'s satellites to track the Secret Avengers	–	✓ 100%
Ragnarok	A perfect copy of Thor's power , with a cybernetic hammer	Kills Goliath; beats Cap's team in the first battle	–	✓ 100%
Everyone else	As in their own films	Their best moments, especially the airport-sized battle at the Baxter Building	–	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	After a disaster kills 600 people, the government orders every hero to register. Captain America says no, and Iron Man hunts him for it. The Avengers break in two, just as the universe's greatest threat is about to arrive.
Theme	Freedom vs. security. Both sides are right, and that's the tragedy.
Villain / antagonist	Nobody, and everybody. Cap and Iron Man are both right. Nitro starts it. Ragnarok kills. Behind all of it is the question itself.

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: STAMFORD

- **Monday, January 11, 2016.** Stamford, Connecticut. The young **New Warriors**, filming a reality show, go after the villain **Nitro** near an elementary school. **He explodes. 600 people are dead, 60 of them children.**
- The nation turns on its heroes. Congress passes the **Superhuman Registration Act.**
- **Tony Stark**, haunted by Stamford, **backs it. Cap refuses:** *"It's the government telling heroes who to fight."*
- S.H.I.E.L.D. tries to arrest Cap on a Helicarrier. He jumps out without a parachute and goes underground.

ACT TWO: WHOSE SIDE ARE YOU ON?

- **The Secret Avengers:** Cap, the Falcon, Hawkeye, Goliath, and eventually the Scarlet Witch, Black Panther, Sue and Johnny Storm.
- **Tony's side:** Black Widow, Yellowjacket, the Wasp, the Vision, War Machine, Mr. Fantastic and Spider-Man.
- Tony convinces Peter to **unmask on live TV:** *"I'm Peter Parker, and I've been Spider-Man since I was fifteen."*
- **The first battle.** The Secret Avengers walk into a trap, and Tony, Reed and Hank bring out **"Ragnarok," a clone of Thor.** It's Thor's face, and it's empty. **Ragnarok kills Goliath.**
- Horrified, **Sue Storm** leaves Reed and takes Johnny with her. **Ben Grimm** refuses to fight his friends and **leaves for France.**
- Peter sees **Prison 42** in the **Negative Zone**, where registration's resisters are being held without trial, and **switches sides.**
- **The Punisher** joins Cap and **executes two villains.** Cap beats him down and throws him out: *"We're not like you."*
- **Bucky**, back in the shadows, helps Cap in secret.

ACT THREE: TIMES SQUARE

- The final battle through **Times Square**, every hero on both sides.
- **Cap vs. Iron Man.** Cap tears the helmet off. **He's winning.**
- A group of **first responders** (firemen, cops and paramedics) tackles Cap to the ground.
- Cap looks around at the wrecked city and **the civilians running.**

CAP: *"We're not fighting for the people anymore. Look at us. We're just fighting."*

- **He surrenders.**

- **Tony becomes Director of S.H.I.E.L.D.** He won. On a Helicarrier over New York, he's never looked so alone.

- Cap, in handcuffs and a prison jumpsuit, is led into a cell. **Bucky** watches from a rooftop across the street.

5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, January 11, 2016 (Stamford) → Saturday, April 9, 2016 (Times Square). The post-credit scene is undated.
Where it's set	Stamford, Connecticut · Washington, D.C. (Congress) · New York City (Times Square, the Baxter Building, a Secret Avengers hideout in Brooklyn) · Prison 42, the Negative Zone (filmed on location in New York, Connecticut and Atlanta)
Relative to other films	Five months after <i>Silver Surfer</i>. The Surfer is stranded on Earth and refuses to take a side.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **The Registration Act, Prison 42, and Tony as Director of S.H.I.E.L.D.**
- **Spider-Man's identity is public**, and it has consequences (Phase 3).
- **Goliath's death; Cap in prison; the Avengers broken.**

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
The Avengers are split	The whole film	The Phase 3 Avengers films
Spider-Man's identity is out	Aunt May is now a target	<i>The Amazing Spider-Man 2</i>
Black Panther	He takes a side	<i>Black Panther</i> (Phase 3)
The Punisher	Thrown out by Cap	A future street-level story (the R-rated label)
The Negative Zone	Prison 42	FF / Phase 3

Setting up the Big Bad

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Mephisto's pleasure	The post-credit scene	The heroes are broken at exactly the worst moment.
Death's temple	The post-credit scene	On 616 (<i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i> #1), Thanos builds a shrine to Death and tries to win her with gifts.

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✓ "RAFT." Cap's prison cell. The lights flicker. Bucky is standing in the cell; nobody saw him come in. BUCKY: <i>"Want to get out of here?"</i> CAP: <i>"No. I surrendered, Buck. I meant it."</i> Bucky sits down on the floor beside the bars. He stays.
Post-credit scene	✓ "THE COURTSHIP." Thanos's world. He's built a vast temple to Death out of the bones of dead stars. Death walks through it and doesn't look at him. Mephisto watches Earth in a pool of fire: the Avengers tearing each other apart in Times Square. He laughs. MEPHISTO: <i>"Look at them, Titan. Earth's mightiest heroes. Divided. Beaten. Blind."</i> THANOS (still watching Death): <i>"I don't care about Earth."</i> MEPHISTO (smiling): <i>"Oh... you will. There is only one gift great enough for her. Half of everything that lives."</i> Thanos goes still. He looks at the Gauntlet. CUT TO BLACK. "CAPTAIN AMERICA WILL RETURN."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: "VISITING HOURS." Post-credit: "CHAPEL."

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline